

*yadi hy aham na varteyam, jatu karmany atandritah
mama vartmanuvartante, manusyah partha sarvasah*

यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः॥ 23॥

For, if I did not engage in work, O Partha, certainly all men would follow My path.

Swami Ji's perspectives

- The leaders set the behavioral standards and values
- The masses imitate leaders, heroes in morals
- Universe needs activity to sustain itself
- God/Purusha though inactive serves as being the substratum

Thoughts / Questions

- Why people choose and then follow a leader?
- Why should the Lord serve? Being vs working?
- Purusha vs Prakriti and Krishna (a Purusha) acting within the bounds of Prakriti
- Krishna, playing the role of an advisor as per the script created by Prakriti, wants Arjuna to act and enact the critical role



*utsideyur ime loka, na kuryam karma ced aham
sankarasya ca karta syam, upahanyam imah prajah*

उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्या कर्म चेदहम्।
संकरस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः॥ 24
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If I should cease to work, then all these worlds would be put to ruination. I would also be the cause of creating unwanted population, and I would thereby destroy the peace of all sentient beings.

Swami Ji's perspectives

- If I fail to perform work, the world will perish
- Nature's laws will tumble down
- Universe is Cosmos & not Chaos, the scientific enquiry is to understand the laws of Prakriti
- Laws of outer world + inner world
- Varnasankara - There will be confusion in behavior and instability in character due to abandonment of duties

Thoughts / Questions

- What are some problems created by inaction?
- Universe as organized chaos, which gets expressed creatively in various forms but the central governing laws remain
- Laws of inner world lead to division of labor, leads to an orderly society where roles are defined based on sanskara or personality types (without rigid hierarchies)



*saktah karmany avidvamso, yatha kurvanti bharata
kuryad vidvams tathasaktas, cikirsur loka-sangraham*

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम्॥
25॥

As the ignorant perform their duties with attachment to results, similarly the learned may also act, but without attachment, for the sake of leading people on the right path.

Swami Ji's perspectives

- While ignorant act for attachments, anxieties for material gain
- Why should a learned, awakened person act?
 - Even if they are unattached
- Mind needs attachment to stay alive
- Loksangraha - desirous of guiding the world
- Attachment is egocentric - poison that can destroy
- Identify with larger sections and then attachment to welfare becomes a cure, just like diluted poison acts as medicine

Thoughts / Questions

- Examples in history of taking poison to develop immunity (Chandragupta, Mithridates etc)
- Head of the government - strongest example of Loksangraha, yet it attracts the most egocentric,
 - Attachment to influence, power, titles, validation
- Zoom in on action, rather than attachment to the role



* any similarity with living or dead is purely coincidental :)